



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Johnson Ferry Christian Academy
School Website: <https://jfca.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Johnson Ferry Christian Academy (JFCA) presents a strongly religious, Christ-centered educational program rooted in Scripture and a biblical worldview. Public materials emphasize discipleship, godly character, worship, and partnership with families and the church, all within a college-style, faith-centered model. Across the six classical criteria, the school demonstrates clear CLASSICAL alignment in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Faculty, and Parents & Community; clear but not fully developed alignment in School Purpose and Goal and in Pedagogy; and limited alignment in Curriculum. Overall, the school is CLASSICAL, with some notable classical practices and several opportunities to deepen its classical formation (especially in curriculum content and pedagogy). See category-by-category details below.

Key evidence includes: clear statements of Christ-centered, biblical worldview and Scripture-guided instruction; worship and discipleship as central; a family/Church partnership orientation; a hybrid-model schedule that intertwines faith-based instruction with parental engagement; accreditation information; and explicit parental involvement requirements. Citations to the school's materials and to the classical-education keyword framework are provided after each section.

- Core religious/metaphysical orientation and liturgical/community practices are explicit in JFCA public materials, including statements about Christ-centered education, Scripture as objective truth, and worship experiences.
- The school's public materials emphasize formation of character and virtue within a biblical framework, and a home-and-church extension of education, rather than a narrow vocational focus.
- Curriculum is described as a Christian hybrid-model with limited emphasis on classical Great Books or the trivium/quadrivium; the pedagogy described centers on on-campus days and faith-based instruction with parental engagement, rather than explicit Socratic/recitation-based classical methods.
- Parents and community are actively involved and welcomed; parents are described as partners and co-educators, with explicit emphasis on parental engagement and home-school alignment.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Details

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a Christ-centered, biblically grounded program. Public materials state the education is “Christ-centered, accredited” and “grounded in Christ, the Scriptures, and the Biblical worldview,” with discipleship and the development of godly character.

- The school characterizes its affiliation with a church and its aim to nurture the student through biblical study, worship, and service, including being an extension of home and Church. - All classroom instruction and decision-making are guided by Scripture and the school's Statement of Faith.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, Scripture, theology (interpreted via biblical worldview and Scripture), worship, liturgy, discipleship, God-centered/holy and sacred imagery, Christian worldview, Christian discipleship, gospel-centered formation, and moral formation through faith. Specific textual anchors include references to objective truth in Scripture and biblically integrated instruction.

- Negative keywords present: None identified in public materials.

Why this rating - The explicit focus on Christ-centered education, Scriptural authority, worship, and church-home partnership strongly aligns with CLASSICAL expectations for a religious/metaphysical foundation (Element 1). The presence of liturgical/community elements (worship and sacred study) reinforces a robust religious orientation. While not all positive keyword types in the category's lexicon appear verbatim (e.g., explicit “liturgical calendar” or “catechesis” terms), the substance clearly satisfies transcendental moral realism and theological grounding as described by the classical rubric. Therefore, CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes formation of character and virtue in a biblically framed context, aiming to develop students into mature leaders who love and serve Christ. Language includes “discipleship,” “godly character,” and “the purpose of fulfilling God's calling.” - The admissions/vision statements emphasize partnership with Christian families and forming students to lead themselves as curious, critical thinkers who serve the world “grounded in their faith.” - The program is described as a college-style model and as a ministry that forms students spiritually, academically, and relationally, with an emphasis on “home and Church extension” and parental engagement.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom (via formation of godly character and intellectual growth), moral imagination (implied by character formation in a biblical context), love of learning, and great conversation (though not explicitly labeled as such, “discourse” and “discipleship” imply Socratic-like formation). The lexicon document identifies “formation,” “virtue,” “wisdom,” “moral imagination,” and “great conversation” as positive indicators; the materials show formation/character growth and a biblically framed pursuit of truth and righteousness. - Negative keywords present: None obviously indicated; there is no explicit emphasis on workforce-preparation or purely utilitarian aims in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The public materials foreground formation, virtue, and wisdom within a theologically grounded framework and emphasize character formation over mere information transfer. However, the explicit classical markers such as universal calls to Great Books, liberal arts formation, or explicit pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful through a classical canon are not prominent. The school's aim aligns with classical formation ideals but does not demonstrate full classical curriculum and pedagogical structures in the public content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 2.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a Christian hybrid-model curriculum with on-campus days for certain grades and faith-based instruction, plus parental engagement. There is no explicit mention of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or the Quadrivium, Great Books, or the Great Conversation; no explicit reference to classical canon or Latin/Greek study in the public materials. - The Academics page emphasizes a school-wide Christian worldview and biblical integration rather than a canonical classical curriculum. -

Accreditation and program descriptions focus on Christian, college-style, and hybrid models rather than traditional liberal-arts canonical structures.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: references to “Great Books,” “Seven Liberal Arts” and related classical terms do not appear in public content; thus, none of the explicit positive Curriculum keywords (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, historical integration, etc.) are evidenced in the site materials. The school does mention “biblical worldview” integration as a form of curriculum, which is not among the explicit positive Curriculum keywords in the Six Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords present: absence of Socratic dialogue, Great Books, or Trivium/Quadrivium language; lack of explicit recitation/memorization practices; no evidence of a traditional classical curriculum. The lack of these classical curriculum signals constitutes negative indicators for CATEGORY 3 per the lexicon.

Why this rating - The school's curriculum is described in terms of Christian, hybrid-model instruction with home/church integration rather than the canonical liberal-arts curriculum and Great Books approach central to classical education. The absence of explicit classical curriculum elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; trivium/quadrivium) leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Academics page describes a hybrid schedule (on-campus two days for middle/high and 2.5 days for K–5) and notes “a combination of the best attributes of a traditional classroom, faith-based instruction, and parental engagement.” The described model centers on structure and faith integration rather than explicit classical teaching methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, recitation, or structured memory work). - Public materials emphasize faith-based instruction and parental engagement; no explicit mention of Socratic seminars, memory work, chanting, or the traditional classical pedagogy elements (e.g., recitation, progymnasmata, or formal rhetoric training) in the public content.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: none of the standard Pedagogy-positive indicators (Socratic seminars, narration/recitation, chanting, scholé, rhetoric training, etc.) appear explicitly in public content. The presence of a hybrid, faith-based approach is not itself a classical pedagogy signal. - Negative keywords present: absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals such as Socratic dialogue, formal memory work, or rigorous rhetoric training in the public content. The lexicon lists traditional methods like Socratic seminars and recitation as positive indicators; their absence is a negative signal for Element 4.

Why this rating - The pedagogy described centers on a hybrid, faith-based model with limited evidence of classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue, memorization, or rhetoric-focused training). While the approach may be rigorous and formation-focused, it does not demonstrate the core classical pedagogy signals. Therefore, Element 4 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials present faculty as a community of committed, godly teachers who mentor students; several bios emphasize teachers' professional background, faith commitments, and role in student formation. The Head of School and other leaders are highlighted, signaling a structured leadership and a living model of instruction.

- Descriptions of staff as “the living curriculum” and “model teachers and mentors” are echoed in classical-education language within the knowledge-base lexicon, and the site emphasizes relationships, character formation, and mentorship. While the site does not explicitly write “living curriculum” in those words, the bios and staff roles imply a culture of virtuous mentorship and teacher-student partnerships. - The faculty are described as involved in various divisions (lower/upper school), with a culture of collaboration and discipleship.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: teacher as mentor, model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, moral exemplars, mentorship, and character formation. The Six Elements lexicon lists “model teachers and mentors,” “portrait of a teacher” and “living curriculum” as positive indicators for Element 5. - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Why this rating - The site presents a cohesive faculty culture centered on mentorship, virtue, and living the curriculum in a community-oriented way, aligning with classical expectations for the faculty category. While explicit classical vocabulary (e.g., “living curriculum” phrase usage) is not always spelled out in the public materials, the evidence strongly supports CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, viewing parents as co-teachers and aligning with home/Church formation. The Admissions page frames the school as a ministry that partners with Christian families to educate and inspire their children; signage of parent involvement and home-school alignment is clear. - The FAQ and other pages stress active parental participation in education, with parents playing a central role in supporting the student’s formation within a college-style program and the school’s mission. - The Parents page and Get-to-Know-Us materials show a partnership approach, with content oriented toward parent formation, family involvement, and parent access to school events and information.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, home-school alignment, open campus, parent involvement, family catechesis, and school-parent synergy. The lexicon’s positive keywords for Element 6 include “partnership with families,” “parent formation,” and “home-centered learning,” which align with JFCA’s public materials. - Negative keywords present: none observed.

Why this rating - The school presents a robust, explicit partnership with parents and a welcoming, open community that invites ongoing parental engagement and formation, which matches the CLASSICAL indicators for Element 6.

What Would Move the Needle

- Since Element 2 is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, the needle could move toward a more robust CLASSICAL alignment by:
 - Explicitly integrating classical curriculum content (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, and the Great Conversation) into the formal curriculum narrative, with documented course materials and reading lists.
 - Introducing explicit Socratic pedagogy (Socratic seminars, dialectic discussions) in upper grades and a structured memory/recitation program (chanting, oral narration) consistent with classical practices.
 - Embedding a formal “liturgy of learning” schedule that reflects scholé-inspired contemplative time, restful learning, and memorization routines.
 - Highlighting a formal living-curriculum approach with explicit descriptions of classical teacher training, mentorship, and exemplars for both students and faculty.
- For Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy), to reach CLASSICAL, the school could:
 - Add explicit references to classical curricular components (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a sequence of studies implementing the trivium and quadrivium.
 - Publicly document a classical pedagogy plan, including structured practice in memorization, recitation, and rhetorical exercises; increase opportunities for Socratic dialogue and formal debates in the upper grades.
- For Element 5 (Faculty) and Element 6 (Parents & Community), the school already demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment; continued emphasis on mentor-teacher models, a robust “living curriculum” approach, and ongoing parent formation opportunities would strengthen these categories further.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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